

Year 4 Reading Comprehension - Saving Water in the School Garden

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0: AC9E4LY05 - use comprehension strategies to build literal and inferred meaning, expand ideas and evaluate texts.

Learning Intention

Read an informational text and explain cause, effect and practical solutions.

Reading Strategy

Look for problem and solution words such as because, so, instead and therefore.

Vocabulary Helper

mulch - material placed on soil to help keep moisture in

evaporate - to change from liquid into vapour and disappear into the air

efficient - working well without waste

Saving Water in the School Garden

During a dry month, the Year 4 garden beds began to look tired. The lettuce leaves drooped in the afternoon and the soil cracked near the tomato plants. Instead of watering for longer, the class decided to investigate smarter ways to care for the garden.

First, they checked the soil before watering. If the soil was still damp below the surface, they waited. Next, they added mulch around the plants. Mulch helped slow evaporation, so the soil stayed moist for longer. The students also watered early in the morning, before the day became hot.

Their teacher showed them how to use a watering can near the roots instead of spraying the leaves. This helped water reach the part of the plant that needed it most. The class also collected rainwater in a covered tub after a storm.

After two weeks, the garden looked healthier. The students learnt that saving water does not mean ignoring plants. It means using water carefully, at the right time and in the right place. Their small changes made the garden stronger and taught them how careful choices can protect resources.

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Page 2 - Questions and written response

Warm Up - Quick check

Circle the type of text: Story / Information text / Poem

Build Your Skills

1. What problem did the Year 4 garden have?

2. Why did the class check the soil before watering?

3. How did mulch help the plants?

4. Why did the students water early in the morning?

5. What did the teacher show students to do with the watering can?

6. What is the main message of the text?

Reading Challenge

Choose one water-saving idea from the text and explain why it is effective.

I Can Checklist

- ☐ I can read carefully.
- ☐ I can use evidence.
- ☐ I can answer in full sentences.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____



High Five!

You connected causes, effects and solutions. That is strong reader thinking!

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Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Warm Up answer: Information text.

Detailed answers

1. The garden beds looked tired, leaves drooped and soil cracked during a dry month.
2. They checked so they would not water if the soil was still damp below the surface.
3. Mulch slowed evaporation and helped the soil stay moist for longer.
4. They watered early before the day became hot, reducing water loss.
5. The teacher showed them how to water near the roots instead of spraying the leaves.
6. The main message is that people can save water by using it carefully, at the right time and in the right place.

Challenge answer: Accept answers about checking soil, mulching, watering in the morning, watering roots or collecting rainwater, with a clear reason.

Parent Tip - At Home

At home, let your child be the Water Detective. Ask them to find one way your family can save water without making it boring.

Teacher Tip - In Class

After reading, ask students to label each garden idea as a problem, solution or effect. This supports cause-and-effect comprehension.

Extension Idea

Design a small sign for a school garden explaining one smart water-saving rule.